



API Setup & Resources Guide

HackAI 4.0 — Official Participant Handbook

Prepare all required API credentials before the event begins.

⚠ **Important:** Please complete all the steps in this guide before arriving at the hackathon. Having your API credentials ready will save valuable project time.

1. Hugging Face Token

A Hugging Face account and access token are required to pull pre-trained models and datasets from the Hub, as well as to publish your project outputs.

Account Creation

1. Visit huggingface.co/join and create a free account if you do not already have one.

Generating an Access Token

2. Sign in to your account and navigate to [Settings → Access Tokens](#).
3. Click **New Token**, provide a descriptive name, and select the **Read/Write** permission level.
4. Copy the generated token immediately — it will not be displayed again.

Storing Your Token

5. Store the token as an environment variable or a Colab Secret under the name:
HF_TOKEN

2. Google AI Studio API Key

Google AI Studio provides access to Gemini models through a free-tier API. Use this key to integrate generative AI capabilities into your project.

6. Navigate to [Google AI Studio](#) and sign in with a Google account.
7. Click **Create API Key** to generate a new key.
8. Verify that the billing plan is set to **"Sans frais" (Free Tier)** to avoid unexpected charges.
9. Save the key securely for use in your project configuration.

3. Groq API Key

Groq offers ultra-fast inference for open-source LLMs. Its free tier is well-suited for rapid prototyping and real-time applications.

10. Go to the [Groq Console](#) and create an account.
11. Select **API Keys** from the left-hand navigation and click **Create API Key**.
12. Copy and store the key in a secure location.

4. Weights & Biases (W&B) Account

Weights & Biases is a machine learning platform for experiment tracking, model evaluation, and training diagnostics. It is highly recommended for monitoring your model throughout the hackathon.

13. Sign up or log in at [wandb.ai](#).
14. Retrieve your API key from [wandb.ai/authorize](#).
15. During training, use **wandb.init()** to automatically begin logging metrics.

5. Additional Free LLM API Providers

The following providers offer free-tier access to a range of large language models. Participants may use any of these to supplement their primary API integrations.

Provider	Link	Notes
NVIDIA NIM	build.nvidia.com	NVIDIA-hosted models
OpenRouter	openrouter.ai	Unified access to many LLMs

6. Recommended Learning Resources

We encourage all participants to review the following resources before the event. Familiarity with these topics will significantly accelerate your project development.

Transformer Architecture

- Jay Alammar's Illustrated Transformer — jalammar.github.io/illustrated-transformer

LLM Agents

- A Visual Guide to LLM Agents — newsletter.maartengrootendorst.com

Agent Frameworks (Hands-On)

- LangChain Foundations — academy.langchain.com (LangChain Course)
- LangGraph Introduction — academy.langchain.com (LangGraph Course)

Voice Agents

- Deep Dive into Voice Agents — [HuggingFace Blog](https://huggingface.co/blog)
- Build a Voice Agent with LiveKit — [YouTube Playlist](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=...)
- Build a Voice Agent with Pipecat — [YouTube Tutorial](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=...)

7. API Key Security

⚠️ **Never share your API keys publicly or commit them to a Git repository. Treat these credentials with the same care as a password. If a key is accidentally exposed, revoke it immediately from the provider's dashboard.**

For any questions or technical difficulties, please reach out to the HackAI organizing team via the official communication channels provided at registration.

Good luck, and happy hacking! 🚀